

OzoneTrckr — Firmware Flow

How a measurement run executes, from cold boot through the loop to deep sleep — and the three independent ways the data gets off the device.

SETUP() runs once on power-up / reset

Wake the hardware safely

The board boots and powers up the analog front-end in the right order — analog off, then a cold start — before anything uses the SPI bus the ADC and screen share, so the ADC never desyncs. `setup()`

Turn on the screen, centre the filter

The TFT lights up (black at first) and the filter servo eases to its middle position. `displayInit()`

Find the sun

TRACKER

The four light sensors steer the two mount servos until all quadrants are equally bright — i.e. pointed at the sun. `sunflowerFindSun()`

Start the clock chip

Bring up the battery-backed real-time clock on the I²C bus; it holds the time even between runs. `rtc.begin()`

Mount the flash storage

FLASH

Open the on-chip filesystem *without* auto-formatting, so a damaged-but-readable previous run still gets a chance to be rescued below. `storageBegin()`

TFT Flash backup ready

Join WiFi and announce the device

WIFI

Connect with a fixed address, advertise the name `ozone.local`, and open a command port so a run can be ended remotely. `commandLinkBegin()`

TFT IP 192.168.1.50

Set the exact time

NTP

Ask an internet time server for the precise UTC and update the clock; if that fails, just trust the clock chip.

`ntpSyncUTC()`

TFT Clock: NTP synced

Rescue the previous run

SERIAL + WIFI

If an earlier run is still on flash, send it out over serial **and** WiFi before it gets overwritten — so a missed upload never loses data. `uploadLastRun()` · `dumpLastRunToSerial()`

TFT Last run sent (WiFi)

Check the flash can be written

FLASH

Only now — after rescue — write-test the filesystem and reformat it only if it is genuinely corrupt.

`storageEnsureWritable()`

Bring up the sensors

Read the weather sensor, load the saved site coordinates (the GPS stays asleep), and configure the ADC and its data-ready interrupt. `setup_ADC_CARD()`

Zero the ADC (dark calibration)

With no light in, measure each channel's offset and noise and load it into the ADC; the values are saved in the file header. `offsetCalibration()`

TFT OFFSET CAL · Ch1 / Ch2

Open the run file

FLASH

Create the rolling CSV, write the header, and confirm the write landed; from here every block is saved as it is measured. `runFileBegin()` → `/lastrun.csv`

TFT Logging to flash

THE RUN

repeats ~every 32 s · 20 readings per loop

Keep WiFi alive

WIFI

Each loop, reconnect at once if the link dropped and nudge it so the router can't quietly kick the device off.

```
wifiKeepalive()
```

Re-aim and work out where the sun is

TRACKER

Every 5th loop the mount re-centres on the sun; every loop the sun's elevation and azimuth are computed from the clock and coordinates. `sunFlowerFindSun()` · `sunPosition()`

Measure through filter 1

Ease the filter to its first position, then take 10 readings — each one measures both channels, saves a row to flash + serial, and refreshes the live screen. `filter_rotation()` · `measurement()` · `storeMeasurement()`

Measure through filter 2

Swap to the second filter position and take 10 more the same way. A stop request never cuts a phase short — you always get a full 10 + 10.

TFT 17:42:05 28/06/26 · Ch1 612.34 Ch2 588.10 — the live dashboard, redrawn every reading

🔄 repeat the loop...

...until any end condition:

- the planned number of readings is reached, or
- the **BOOT button** is pressed (works with no WiFi), or
- a **stop/dump** command arrives over WiFi.

END OF RUN

deliver the data, then sleep

Close the run file

The whole run is already on flash (saved one block at a time), so this just flushes and closes it. `runFileEnd()`

① Serial

Print the CSV to a USB terminal if one is attached — works with no WiFi.
`dumpLastRunToSerial()`

② WiFi → PC

Send the file to the PC's listener; keep retrying for a while (BOOT skips the wait). `uploadLastRun()`

③ Flash (kept)

Stays saved on flash and is re-sent on the next power-up.

TFT Sending data... → Upload done

Park and power down

Return the filter, put the ADC to sleep, cut analog power, cleanly unmount flash, and hold the servo pins steady so they don't twitch. `storageEnd()`

SLEEP

Sleep until the next placement

The board switches fully off with no wake timer; you power-cycle to start the next run — which also re-sends this one if its upload was missed. `esp_deep_sleep_start()`

TFT (display off)

DATA RESILIENCE — 3 CHANNELS

- F Flash** — every block, to `/lastrun.csv`. Survives WiFi loss & battery death.
- S Serial** — live [...] rows during the run, full CSV at end + next boot.
- W WiFi** — TCP upload to the PC's `ncat -l 5000`.

TFT STATUS DOTS

- W WiFi**: green = good, orange **w** = weak, red **x** = down. RSSI shown below.
- F Flash**: green = logging & last write OK; red = off / write failed (live, per block).

NEOPIXEL STATUS (NO-TFT BUILD)

- Per block**: green = flash + WiFi OK · orange = WiFi down (on flash) · red = write failed.
- Setup**: blue = WiFi connecting · cyan = IP/link · green = NTP synced · orange = build-time fallback.
- Actions**: magenta = sending data · green/orange = upload done / kept on flash.

COLOUR = SUBSYSTEM

- setup / general
- measurement & tracker
- WiFi / NTP / TCP
- flash storage (FFat)
- serial / delivery

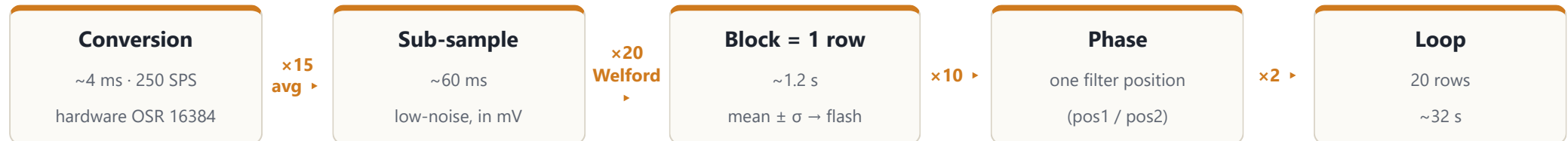
Setup — setup_ADC_CARD()

Device	ADS131M04 — 24-bit, 4-ch simultaneous $\Delta\Sigma$, SPI (bus shared with TFT)
Data rate	~250 SPS · High-Res mode · OSR 16384 (lowest noise)
Channels	CH0 + CH1 stored (CH2 also enabled); differential AINxP/AINxN
PGA gain	1× on CH0 / CH1 / CH2
Full scale	FS = 2^{23} = 8 388 608 counts, scaled to PREF = 1200 mV
Bring-up	RESET → STANDBY → write CLOCK/CFG/THRSHLD → WAKEUP → one flush read

DRDY handshake — GPIO6, falling-edge IRQ

DRDY drops LOW when a conversion is ready and **stays low until the frame is clocked out over SPI** — it is *not* a free-running pulse in this configuration. The ISR sets a **volatile** flag; the sampling loop sees it, clears it, and calls `readADC()`, which reads the 24-bit words and releases DRDY for the next conversion.

So every conversion must be read — an interrupt-only wait with no read would deadlock. A 2 s no-DRDY timeout is the safety net (it flags "analog board disconnected").

Sampling hierarchy — how one stored row is built

Counts → mV: $V = (\Sigma \text{counts} / n) / \text{FS} \times 1200 \text{ mV}$, accumulated in `double`; mean and σ computed with Welford's algorithm for numerical stability. **Settling guard:** after every `CMD_WAKEUP` (i.e. each filter move) the first **25 conversions (~100 ms) are discarded** so the wake transient never lands in a block. **Offset cal:** 100 zero-input sub-samples are averaged into the ADC's hardware offset register and reported as mean $\pm \sigma$ in the CSV header. **Quiet windows:** the ADC is put to `STANDBY` during every filter-servo move, so servo current spikes and SPI traffic never coincide with sampling.

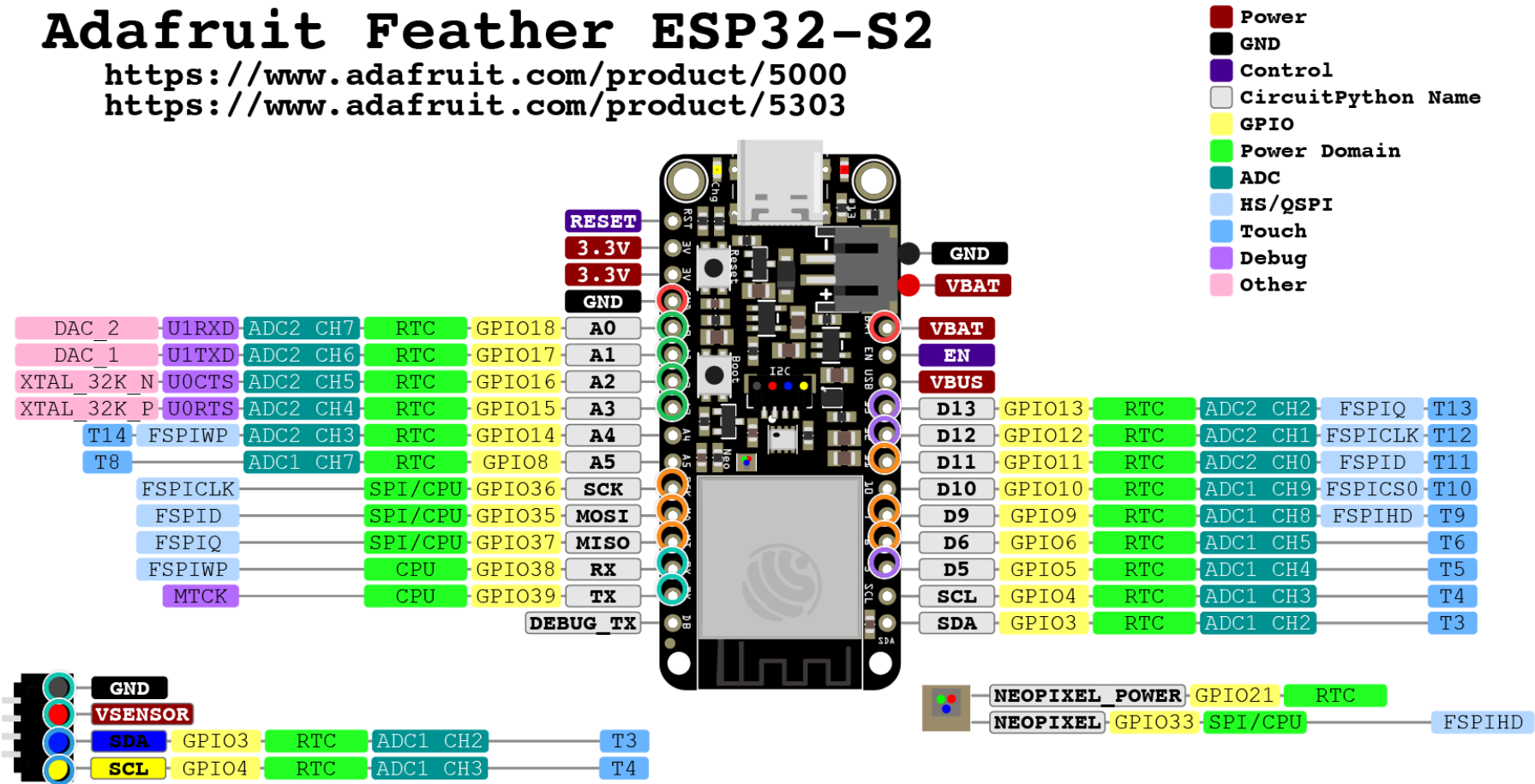
PINS

Feather ESP32-S2 header pins used by the instrument

Adafruit Feather ESP32-S2

<https://www.adafruit.com/product/5000>

<https://www.adafruit.com/product/5303>



Stemma QT Power pin VSENSOR and I2C pull-up resistors are enabled/disabled by GPIO 7.
 If you have a rev B board, set IO7 LOW to enable.
 If you have a rev C board, set IO7 HIGH to enable.

ADC board — SPI + control Servos LDR sun sensors I²C sensors (STEMMA QT) GPS — UART + power Analog-board power

PINS

GPIO assignments — what each marked pin does

PIN	GPIO	FUNCTION	SUBSYSTEM
SCK	36	ADC SPI clock (shared with TFT)	● ADC board
MOSI	35	ADC SPI MOSI	● ADC board
MISO	37	ADC SPI MISO	● ADC board
D11	11	analog-board power enable (EN)	● ADC board
D9	9	ADC chip-select (CS)	● ADC board
D6	6	ADC data-ready (DRDY, interrupt)	● ADC board
D13	13	tracker servo — vertical (elevation)	● Servos
D12	12	tracker servo — horizontal (azimuth)	● Servos
D5	5	filter servo (pos1 / pos2 / cal)	● Servos
A0	18	LDR bottom-left	● Sun sensors
A1	17	LDR top-right	● Sun sensors
A2	16	LDR bottom-right	● Sun sensors
A3	15	LDR top-left	● Sun sensors
SDA	3	I ² C data — DS3231 RTC + BME280 (via STEMMA QT)	● I ² C sensors
SCL	4	I ² C clock — DS3231 RTC + BME280 (via STEMMA QT)	● I ² C sensors
RX	38	GPS UART RX (module TX → Feather)	● GPS
TX	39	GPS UART TX (Feather → module RX)	● GPS
VSENSOR	—	GPS + I ² C-sensor power (STEMMA QT)	● GPS
VBAT	—	analog-board supply (+)	● Power
GND	—	analog-board ground	● Power

Not a header pin, so not marked above: **GPIO0** = the onboard **BOOT** button (WiFi-free early-stop). The DS3231 RTC and BME280 share the **STEMMA QT** connector (SDA/SCL + VSENSOR/GND); the GPS taps the same connector's **VSENSOR/GND** for power but talks over the header **RX/TX** (GPIO38/39) — it is held in backup/asleep this build, so its UART is idle and coordinates are hardcoded. The **analog board** is powered from **VBAT + GND**; the three servos run off a separate 5 V supply that shares ground with the Feather.

TFT

what the 240×135 ST7789 shows, in run order

Flash backup ready

Setup · flash — FFat mounted (red FLASH MOUNT FAILED if not).

IP 192.168.1.50

Setup · wifi — device address, no serial needed (also `ozone.local`).

Clock: NTP synced

Setup · clock — or Clock: RTC kept / amber Clock: build-time.

Last run sent (WiFi)

Recovery — previous run re-delivered over serial + WiFi before it's overwritten.

OFFSET CAL

Zero-input offset [mV]

Ch1: 0.1240

Ch2: -0.0310

Offset cal — per-channel dark offset, written into the CSV header.

17:42:05

28/06/26

N44.5302 E14.4706

EL +47.32 deg

AZ 215.40 SW

Ch1: 612.34 0.87

Ch2: 588.10 0.92

Live dashboard — redrawn every block (flicker-free, in-place). Top-right: WiFi dot + RSSI (orange **w** weak / red **x** down), flash-health dot. Elevation is colour-coded by sun height.

Sending data ...

End of run — then Upload done (green) or On flash + serial; the panel blanks (`displayOff()`) before deep sleep.

Setup checkpoints — each a short blink**Booting**

dim white — powered on,
cold-booting the ADC.

**Flash OK**

green ×2 — FFat mounted
(red ×3 = mount/format
failed).

**WiFi connecting**

solid blue — joining the
network.

**WiFi + IP**

cyan ×2 — connected,
address acquired (red ×3 =
no WiFi).

**Clock synced**

green-teal ×2 — time set
from NTP.

**Clock fallback**

orange ×3 — NTP failed →
build-time clock.

**Logging**

green ×2 — run file open on
flash (red = serial only).

During the run — one blink per block**All good**

green — flash write OK and
WiFi up.

**WiFi down**

orange — link lost, but the
block is safely on flash.

**Flash failed**

red — the block's flash write
did not commit.

Delivery — end of run**Sending data**

magenta — uploading the
run over WiFi (blinks per
retry).

**Upload done**

green ×3 — the PC received
the file.

**Kept on flash**

orange ×3 — no PC listener;
data safe on flash + serial.

HOST commands you run on the PC — Windows & macOS

TASK	WIN WINDOWS — POWERSHELL	MAC MACOS — TERMINAL (ZSH)
Receive a run start the listener first, then end the run	<code>ncat -l 5000 > data.csv</code>	<code>nc -l 5000 > data.csv</code>
Reach the device	<code>ping ozone.local</code>	<code>ping ozone.local</code> <code>dns-sd -G v4 ozone.local</code>
End run early + send connect, then type <code>send</code> (or <code>stop</code>)	<code>ncat ozone.local 5050</code>	<code>nc ozone.local 5050</code>
Build & flash firmware	<code>pio run -t upload</code>	<code>pio run -t upload</code>
Erase flash enter download mode, close PuTTY first	<code>pio run -t erase</code>	<code>pio run -t erase</code>

Windows needs **Nmap** (for `ncat`) and **Apple Bonjour** to resolve `.local` names; macOS has `nc` and `mDNS` built in. The device connects out to `SECRET_PC_HOST:5000`, so the PC listener must be up *before* the run ends; the remote-stop server lives on the device at `:5050`. If `pio` isn't on `PATH` in PowerShell: `& "$env:USERPROFILE\.platformio\penv\Scripts\platformio.exe" run -t upload`.

OzoneTrckr · ESP32-S2 Feather + ADS131M04 · single rolling file `/lastrun.csv`, per-block commit, NTP clock, mDNS `ozone.local`, flicker-free TFT, latched servo pins on sleep. Working prototype — 2026-06-27.